KCC CODE CLUB · GAME MAKERS

Pre-launch Checklist

Start six weeks out

Start six weeks out. The pilot runs as a KCC club, not a registered Code Club, so there's no external vetting queue to wait on. Two things still have lead times you can't compress:

1. **The Scratch teacher account** — manual approval, several days to a couple of weeks
2. **The skeleton files** — about two hours of your own time, and they must exist before week one

Everything else can be rushed if it has to be. Start those two now.

Six weeks out

- [ ] **Request the Scratch teacher account** at scratch.mit.edu/educators, in the club's name with a club email address. See `scratch-accounts-setup.md`
- [ ] **Confirm the venue**: room, dates, times, key access, who unlocks and locks up
- [ ] **Book the showcase** at the same time — a second hour straight after week eight, or a slot at the next KCC gathering. It doesn't fit in a sixty-minute class, and the date goes in the parent letter
- [ ] **Take the club's child safety policy to the KCC committee** before you commit to dates. Agree what's required of volunteers, what the club's insurance covers, and who the named contact is for any welfare concern. See the note at the bottom of this file
- [ ] **Confirm the term fee** — $40 for the eight weeks ($5 a session), collected up front — and agree how it's collected and, crucially, who can waive it without a meeting
- [ ] Confirm your volunteers for all eight weeks and name the spares

Four weeks out

- [ ] **Set the class size from the staffing ratio** — one volunteer per five students, 1:4 if the group skews young, never fewer than two adults, 16 cap for the pilot
- [ ] **Test the venue wi-fi with as many devices as you plan to run.** Not "the venue has wi-fi" — take five machines down there and load Scratch on all of them
- [ ] **Bring-your-own-laptop for the pilot** — no budget for club machines. Make sure the parent letter says so plainly. See `venue-device-checklist.md`
- [ ] Open registrations. **Cap at 16** (12–15 is the sweet spot with a team of five). Keep a waitlist; it's your case for a second cohort
- [ ] Send `parent-info-letter.md` with the registration link
- [ ] Send `consent-and-photo-permission.md`. **Collect these before week one, not on the day**
- [ ] **Count who the laptop requirement turns away.** Note every family that asks and can't come. That number is the case for sponsored laptops after the pilot

Three weeks out

- [ ] **Build the eight skeleton files.** About two hours. This is the single most valuable preparation task in the programme — see the Long Project guide (`course/long-project-sky-catcher.md`)
- [ ] Create the club Scratch studio and the skeletons studio
- [ ] Run through the week-one lesson plan end to end on the actual venue equipment
- [ ] Confirm the projector works in the room. Bring your own adapter
- [ ] Complete the Raspberry Pi Foundation's free safeguarding e-learning — about 30 minutes, open to anyone, and worth every volunteer's time whether or not the club requires it

One week out

- [ ] Create Scratch accounts for every registered student, and print the login slips
- [ ] Print handouts for weeks one and two
- [ ] Print the attendance sheet
- [ ] Send the reminder email: date, time, address, what to bring, what not to bring
- [ ] Brief every volunteer using `volunteer-briefing.md`, spares included
- [ ] Chase outstanding consent forms

Day of week one

- [ ] Arrive 30 minutes early
- [ ] Every machine on, logged into Scratch, one tab open
- [ ] Projector tested and mirroring
- [ ] Name stickers, pencils, handouts on the desks
- [ ] Your finished Sky Catcher open in a tab, ready to demo
- [ ] Consent forms checked off against the attendance list
- [ ] Water, somewhere away from the laptops — there's no break, so they drink when they need to

Standing weekly routine

Before every class:

- [ ] Read the lesson plan properly. Not skim — read it
- [ ] Print that week's handout
- [ ] Build that week's project checkpoint yourself, so you've hit the bugs first
- [ ] Check who was absent last week and have the right skeleton link ready for them

After every class:

- [ ] Confirm every student saved
- [ ] Back up every project as an `.sb3` to the USB stick

- [ ] Note who's falling behind and message their parent with the skeleton link
- [ ] Write down anything that went wrong while you still remember it

A note on child safety checks

The pilot isn't registered with Code Club Aotearoa, so their police vetting requirement doesn't apply. That removes an external gate, not the underlying question — **decide deliberately with the KCC committee what the club requires of adults working with its children, and write it down.** Insurers sometimes ask, parents occasionally ask, and having an answer ready is better than improvising one.

If the committee does want checks, KCC doesn't need Code Club to get them: organisations can register directly with the New Zealand Police Vetting Service as an approved agency. Allow time for that — it's a separate approval process on top of the vetting turnaround.

Whether or not checks are required, the practical safeguards in `volunteer-briefing.md` stay: two adults in the room at all times, never alone with a child, no private contact with students, no photos on personal phones, and one named person any welfare concern goes to the same day. Those cost nothing and they're what actually protects children on the day.

This is a starting point for that committee conversation, not legal advice — the committee should confirm the club's obligations properly.

If the club registers with Code Club Aotearoa later

Worth revisiting after the pilot. It's free, community venues qualify, it brings a volunteer network and a funding pool, and it makes the "Code Club" name unambiguous. It does require police vetting for every volunteer who isn't a registered teacher, 2–4 weeks each, so it moves this checklist back to an eight-week runway.

Their project library is free to use either way — nothing in this pack depends on being registered.